NSE'S CORE TEAM



DR R.H. PATIL
Founder, Managing Director, NSE
The architect of NSE, he revolutionised and democratised stock trading. Died in 2012, aged 74



RAVI NARAIN
Former chairman, NSE
Was part of the government committee set up in the late 1980s to suggest an overhaul of stock markets and was one of the members who recommended the setting up of NSE. A key member of the founding team, he stepped down in 2017 and was one of the 15 people SEBI sent a showcause notice to in the co-location case. Currently being questioned by CBI



CHITRA RAMKRISHNA
Former CEO, NSE
Part of NSE's founding team along with other colleagues from the IDBI, she rose to become its joint managing director in 2009 and was promoted to CEO in April 2013. While she transformed NSE into one of the most modern exchanges in the world in this time, she also started attracting allegations of corporate misgovernance. Currently under arrest and in CBI custody



RAGHAVAN PUTHRAN
Now reportedly at an ashram near Kolkata
Was with IDBI, before joining NSE in 1993. Quit around 2002 after the Harshad Mehta scam to join the Yogananda ashram in Kolkata



ASHISH CHAUHAN
MD and CEO, BSE
Part of NSE's founding team and worked there from 1993-2000



K. KUMAR
MD and CEO, ICCL
Was part of the founding team of NSE and worked at NSE from 1993-99

nian's bank statement that shows a payment of Rs 2.4 lakh made to the hotel around the same time.

SEBI whole-time member Ananta Barua, however, has held that the report doesn't conclusively prove that Subramanian is the yogi. Market insiders don't buy that story. The communication between the yogi and Ramkrishna included details and conversations about internal movements in the company. Like this excerpt from the SEBI report: "Seema is a darling child, she requires polishing, everyone has a godfather for [their] growth... so she can be promoted and moved to SME as head and also be management representative for business excellence... Rachana may be moved back as regulatory head... Tojo to Kolkata and Achal to Delhi..."

Though SEBI isn't convinced that Subramanian is the mystery yogi who was in the know of the minute details of the NSE's functioning, he does emerge as the clear beneficiary of the yogi's directions. The mail trail shows the yogi appearing to demand a cut of Subramanian's pay—"Kanchan to withdraw and surrender to me per month as gratitude on gross amount," reads a mail cited in the EY report. However, as 'Kanchan' is an alias for Subramanian, who is also believed to be the yogi, this may be an attempt at misdirection.

Moreover, while Ramkrishna has said she had been following the yogi's directions for 20 years, and the yogi clearly has intricate knowledge of not just the NSE's structure and functioning, but also about equity markets, Subramanian had no experience in the field before joining the NSE. Those who have worked with him have also raised doubts about his technical skills. Also, it is difficult to believe that Ramkrishna and Subramanian, whose camaraderie is well known, would leave a mail trail when their cabins were interconnected and they could easily have shared information face-to-face. The yogi's emails relate to internal matters of the NSE—promotions, listing, board seats and so on—and he understands the organisation like an old-timer would. The information shared includes NSE's dividend payout, organisation structure, financial results, human resources policy, business plans and appraisals—details that senior management would be privy to.

While dismissing EY's suggestion that Subramanian is the yogi, SEBI didn't try to find out who might have been using the rigyajursama email ID. According to Nishant Singh, founder and MD of Forensic Investigation and Consultancy Services, any state cyber cell can identify the mysterious person by finding the locations from where the email account was accessed. "It's really not a big deal at all," he says.